

[SDESK-5] Finance Control Panel Restriction GPO Scope Mismatch

Created: 14/May/26 Updated: 14/May/26 Due: 14/May/26 Resolved:

14/May/26

Status:	Done
Project:	IT Service Desk
Components:	None
Affects versions:	None
Fix versions:	None

Type:	Task	Priority:	Medium
Reporter:	David Dufour	Assignee:	David Dufour
Resolution:	Done	Votes:	0
Labels:	GPOs		
Remaining Estimate:	1 hour		
Time Spent:	Not Specified		
Original estimate:	1 hour		

Attachments:	Finance Control Panel Restriction GPO Scope Mismatch 2026-05-14.png sdesk-5-verification-TestUserFin-added-to-CP-Restricted-GPO-2026-05-14.png
Team:	
Request language:	English
Request participants:	None
Organizations:	None

Description

Post GPO Deployment audit revealed a scope mismatch regarding a single user in the Finance dept and the Control Panel Restricted GPO. 1. 1. Symptoms - GPO scope mismatch identified during a post deployment audit revealing TestUserFin excluded from original rollout 1. 1. Scope / Impact - Affected user(s):TestUserFin - Device(s): Windows AD Client Workstation - Department: Finance - Business impact: Low 1. 1. Environment - Hostname: WindowsADClient - OS:Windows 10 Pro - Location/VPN: Internal system/domain-connected workstation - Related systems/services:Active Directory 1. 1. Baseline Checks - Connectivity: User group access and policy application intact - Account status: No issues with TestUserFin user account aside from GPO exclusion - Licensing/access: N/A - Error messages: N/A - Recent changes: GPO restricting the use of Control Panel utility applied to Finance Users 1. 1. Troubleshooting Performed 1. Reviewed membership of Finance Users using powershell 2. Verified GPO_Finance_Restrict_ControlPanel was active and applied to the correct group 3. Reviewed membership of GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted group 4. Compared membership of Finance OU and GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted group 5. Verified mismatch in GPO deployment using powershell revealing the exclusion of TestUserFin 6. Added TestUserFin to GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted 7. Verified TestUserFin no longer has access to control panel utility
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1. 1. Findings

- GPO failed to apply to user due to lack of membership to GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted group.
- Added the user to the correct group via powershell
- Verified the policies application after adding the user

1. 1. Root Cause

- User was not added to the correct group the policy was assigned to.

1. 1. Resolution

- Added the user to the proper group and verified policy's application

1. 1. Validation

- User confirmed: Confirmed via powershell that user is now a member of GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted
- edit: Validated affected user membership in GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted.
- Functionality tested: via powershell Edit: Confirmed GPO_Finance_Restrict_ControlPanel applie successfully.
- Additional verification: via powerhell Edit: Confirmed ControlPanel access restriction enforced.

1. 1. Closure Notes

- Post GPO deployment audit revealed that TestUserFin lacked membership to GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted, resulting in the policies failure to apply. Restricted users access to Control Panel utility by adding the user to the group and running powershell commands to verify successful membership and policy application.

Comments

Comment by [David Dufour](#) [14/May/26]

Built a Finance department user-side GPO named GPO_Finance_Restrict_ControlPanel to restrict access to Control Panel and Windows Settings. The GPO was linked to the Finance Users OU and security-filtered through GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted. Domain Computers retained read access through Delegation permissions to allow proper workstation-side GPO processing.

Validated baseline functionality first using known-good Finance control account SladePinel. Confirmed:

- user received GPO_Finance_Restrict_ControlPanel
- Control Panel and Windows Settings were successfully restricted
- GPO processing, OU linkage, and security filtering functioned correctly

Created the broken-state scenario by intentionally excluding TestUserFin from GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted while keeping the user inside the Finance Users OU. This produced a realistic internal policy scope mismatch where standard Finance policies applied, but the Control Panel restriction GPO did not.

Troubleshooting focused on how an internal IT/admin audit would realistically identify the issue without manually logging into every user account. Used PowerShell to:

- pull all users from the Finance Users OU
- pull all members of GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted
- compare expected Finance users against actual policy-scoped users using Compare-Object
- identify TestUserFin as excluded from the required GPO security group

Validated findings further using gpresult reporting against the affected user context to confirm GPO_Finance_Restrict_ControlPanel was not applying due to security filtering/group membership scope.

Resolution:

- added TestUserFin to GG_Finance_ControlPanel_Restricted via Add-ADGroupMember
- refreshed user policy/logon token
- validated successful GPO application
- confirmed Control Panel and Windows Settings restriction now enforced

Main learning points:

- difference between OU linkage vs GPO security filtering
- importance of policy scope auditing
- distinction between ticket-facing notes and internal engineering/admin notes
- realistic internal audit/compliance style troubleshooting workflow
- using PowerShell to compare expected policy scope vs actual group membership

Comment by [David Dufour](#) [14/May/26]

